

# STORY FORMAT BIBLE: THE REAL-WORLD STORY

---

**STATUS:**  **LOCKED.** The real-world story has NOT started. It begins only when the showrunner gives the word.

This document covers **our story about the people making the MCU**: the actors, the families, the executives and the fans. That's separate from the MCU films themselves, which follow the Franchise Bible.

---

## 1. FORMAT: ENSEMBLE MOCKUMENTARY

**Structure:** an **ensemble story** with **Marc-Anthony Bullock as the primary protagonist**. His journey is the spine and every chapter touches it. Around him the POV rotates among the ensemble: Amond, Tayia, Esther, Tyrese, Harmony, Tyler, Elxa, Grace, Arianna, the Donohue-Bullock family, Kevin Feige and the executives, and the fans.

**The mockumentary conceit:** a documentary crew is embedded with the ensemble. **The footage is sealed** under Marvel NDAs as a time capsule of the secret, to be released only after the Infinity Saga ends. That's why people are candid on camera about a secret the public doesn't know yet.

## The toolkit

| Device                 | How we use it                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Talking heads          | Confessional interviews, always with a <b>lower-third</b> : MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK – Actor, "Tony Stark" – Age 25                                      |
| Fly-on-the-wall scenes | Screenplay format: sets, offices, homes, cars, premieres                                                                                             |
| The look               | A character glances at the camera after something absurd or heartbreaking                                                                            |
| Camera catches it      | Things people didn't know were being filmed: whispered phone calls, hot mics, reactions through a doorway                                            |
| Archival footage       | Clips from <i>SPLAT!</i> , <i>Brainiac</i> , <i>Sunny</i> , Tyrese's music videos, <i>Crime Lab: Baltimore</i> , old Donohue home movies             |
| Media inserts          | Variety, THR, Deadline, <i>Entertainment Tonight</i> , <i>Access Hollywood</i> , talk shows, box office charts                                       |
| The internet           | Forums (SuperHeroHype, AICN, CBR), MySpace, Twitter, YouTube, and later Facebook, Tumblr, Instagram and Reddit as each becomes big in the real world |
| Title cards            | Date, time, location, and a countdown when it matters                                                                                                |
| Bleeps                 | Used as a comedy device. Marc-Anthony's unfiltered mouth runs the censor ragged, and sometimes we just let it play.                                  |

## 2. SERIALIZED vs. STANDALONE

### The target: 80% SERIALIZED / 20% STANDALONE

**Why 80%:** real life doesn't reset between episodes. This is a **twelve-year chronicle (2007–2019)**, and everything that matters builds over time:

- careers and comebacks
- the MCU secret slowly getting out
- the slow-burn romances (Marc & Esther in 2011, Amond & Harmony in 2013)
- the families, and later the kids
- rivalries, box office pressure, and the arrival of social media

**Why 20% standalone:** every chapter still needs its own **self-contained A-story** with a beginning, middle and end:

- a premiere night
- a Comic-Con panel
- an awards show
- a disastrous talk-show appearance

- one 18-hour shoot day
- a Thanksgiving at the Donohue estate

Every tenth chapter or so is a **true standalone "special episode"** that works even if you've never read anything else, like a *Behind the Music*-style retrospective or a fan-convention day told entirely from the fans' side.

## THE CONTINUITY LAWS (real-world story)

1. **The Ledger.** Every chapter opens with date, time and location, and every age is calculated from birthdays. Nobody ages at the wrong time.
  2. **Nothing is forgotten.** Jokes, grudges, injuries, promises, and one-off mentions like "Somebody's getting named Brenda" all come back.
  3. **Real history is fixed.** Real-world events (the 2007–08 writers' strike, the 2008 financial crash, the 2009 Disney deal, the rise of Twitter and Instagram) happen when they really happened, and the story reacts to them.
  4. **The MCU calendar matches the Franchise Bible.** Filming dates, release dates and box office numbers stay consistent across both documents.
  5. **Sealed canon stays sealed** until its date arrives: the relationships, the twins, Lyric, the net worth.
  6. **Characters grow, they never reset.** What happened in Chapter One is still true in Chapter One Hundred.
- 

## 3. GENRE, SUBGENRES & RATING

### Primary genre: Ensemble Comedy-Drama (Mockumentary)

It should make you laugh out loud and then hit you in the chest two pages later.

## Subgenres

| Subgenre                           | What it brings                                                                     | Tonal touchstones                                                          |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Hollywood satire</b>            | Agents, studio politics, trade-paper headlines, box office panic                   | <i>The Larry Sanders Show</i> , <i>Entourage</i> , <i>The Comeback</i>     |
| <b>Workplace mockumentary</b>      | The documentary crew, talking heads, the looks to camera                           | <i>The Office</i> , <i>Parks and Recreation</i> , <i>Abbott Elementary</i> |
| <b>Family saga</b>                 | Three generations of the Donohue–Bullock dynasty, legacy and generational wealth   | <i>This Is Us</i> , <i>Soul Food</i>                                       |
| <b>Underdog sports-movie arc</b>   | A studio that's never made a movie and a cast of typecast actors take on Hollywood | <i>Moneyball</i> , <i>Remember the Titans</i>                              |
| <b>Slow-burn romance</b>           | Friends-to-lovers, years in the making                                             | <i>Love &amp; Basketball</i> , <i>The Best Man</i>                         |
| <b>Comeback / second-act drama</b> | Child stars trying to grow up on screen                                            | <i>The Wrestler</i> , <i>Birdman</i>                                       |
| <b>Media thriller</b> (light)      | Leaks, set photos, spoilers, the fight to keep the secret                          | <i>Spotlight</i> , <i>The Newsroom</i>                                     |

**Tone in one line:** *The Office* meets *Entourage* meets *This Is Us*, with Marc-Anthony at the center.

## Rating: TV-MA (L)

- **Language: uncensored.** Marc-Anthony's comedy is unhinged, unfiltered and offensive by design, and it doesn't work watered down. The bleep is a comedy device, not a rule.
  - **Adult themes:** industry racism, typecasting, money, pressure, grief and fame, handled honestly.
  - **Sexual content: kept off the page.** The romances are about the relationships, not the bedroom.
  - **Heart: 100%.** Once the kids arrive, the story gets warmer without getting softer.
-

## 4. PROTAGONIST & ENSEMBLE MAP

| Tier                | Characters                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary protagonist | Marc-Anthony Bullock                                                                                                                        |
| Core ensemble       | Amond Baker · Esther Smalley · Tayia Boyd · Grace Bullock · Elxa Bullock · Tyrese Avery · Harmony Divine · Tyler Chapman · Arianna Cummings |
| The dynasty         | Victor & Joan Donohue · Natasha & Robert Bullock                                                                                            |
| The studio          | Kevin Feige · David Maisel · Marvel and Disney executives · directors                                                                       |
| Real-life cast      | Samuel L. Jackson, Don Cheadle, Jeff Bridges, Jon Favreau, Stan Lee, and every other real actor per the Casting Rules                       |
| The chorus          | The press and the fans. XxWolverineXx has been locked in as a recurring skeptic since Chapter One.                                          |

---

 NOT STARTED. Waiting for the showrunner's go.